It is the latest competition among the states to impose night curfews to fight COVID-19. Only the Indian establishment could've conjured up a link between the virus & the night.'[13] Many, many others also expressed their opinions on similar lines. Perhaps they came from a place of scientific ignorance, being too involved in their bubble forgetting to look around the world to see what other countries had done and what had worked. South Korea, several European countries such as France, Italy and Belgium[14], heavy caseload states in the US[15] and Sri Lanka[16] were amongst the list of countries which had successfully imposed night curfews even during the first wave of the virus. It took another heavyweight personality like Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw to remind Gupta that even Britain had imposed such a policy measure.[17] While the prime minister gave out his reasoning behind night curfew, several individuals who had lived through disasters and wartime in India were particularly concerned that if millions of people lived in cities without jobs, food and very little or no savings, despair would set in and 'food riots' could become a very real possibility. The prime minister first eliminated desperation arising out of hunger by providing free food grains to every poor family. However, lack of income could still induce despondency. In an interview, former chief statistician and present chairman of the Standing Committee on Economic Statistics, Pronob Sen had expressed a similar concern reiterating, 'It (rioting) has happened before. It wouldn't be a new thing.'[18] If countrywide riots began, we simply didn't have enough police force to bring them under control. A night curfew would at the bare minimum demotivate folks from leaving homes so that those who did venture out could be easily controlled by the cops.

Moving on, the prime minister reminded the chief ministers that during the first wave, the country had successfully managed to bring down active cases from 10 lakh to 1.25 lakh. The same strategies which had worked last time would be effective even now and urged them to implement them in mission mode so as to prevent the peak from going up and bring it down quickly. He repeatedly stressed the need to ramp up testing and prescribed a target of 70 per cent RT-PCR tests, despite the fact that increased testing would obviously lead to higher positive numbers. He appealed,

> The only way out is testing. If the testing leads to a higher figure of positive cases, let it be. The states should not be judged just because of the numbers. Therefore, this is my request to you to come out of